

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL PSYCHOLOGY

PS04

Unit 4 Approaches and Application

Mark scheme

January 2025

Version: 1.0 Final



Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Further copies of this mark scheme are available from [oxfordaqaexams.org.uk](https://www.oxfordaqaexams.org.uk)

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Level of response marking instructions

Level of response mark schemes are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level. There are marks in each level.

Before you apply the mark scheme to a student's answer read through the answer and annotate it (as instructed) to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the mark scheme.

Step 1 Determine a level

Start at the lowest level of the mark scheme and use it as a ladder to see whether the answer meets the descriptor for that level. The descriptor for the level indicates the different qualities that might be seen in the student's answer for that level. If it meets the lowest level then go to the next one and decide if it meets this level, and so on, until you have a match between the level descriptor and the answer. With practice and familiarity you will find that for better answers you will be able to quickly skip through the lower levels of the mark scheme.

When assigning a level you should look at the overall quality of the answer and not look to pick holes in small and specific parts of the answer where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different levels of the mark scheme you should use a best fit approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the level, ie if the response is predominantly level 3 with a small amount of level 4 material it would be placed in level 3 but be awarded a mark near the top of the level because of the level 4 content.

Step 2 Determine a mark

Once you have assigned a level you need to decide on the mark. The descriptors on how to allocate marks can help with this. The exemplar materials used during standardisation will help. There will be an answer in the standardising materials which will correspond with each level of the mark scheme. This answer will have been awarded a mark by the Lead Examiner. You can compare the student's answer with the example to determine if it is the same standard, better or worse than the example. You can then use this to allocate a mark for the answer based on the Lead Examiner's mark on the example.

You may well need to read back through the answer as you apply the mark scheme to clarify points and assure yourself that the level and the mark are appropriate.

Indicative content in the mark scheme is provided as a guide for examiners. It is not intended to be exhaustive and you must credit other valid points. Students do not have to cover all of the points mentioned in the Indicative content to reach the highest level of the mark scheme.

An answer which contains nothing of relevance to the question must be awarded no marks.

Section A: Approaches in Psychology**Total for this section: 30 marks**

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
01	According to the cognitive approach what is meant by a schema? Award marks as follows: 2 marks for a clear definition of a schema. 1 mark for a muddled or vague definition of a schema. Possible content • A mental structure that contains our knowledge and understanding of the world based on our experiences. • A mental structure which interprets new information using stored knowledge and past experience. Credit alternative wording.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
02	According to the cognitive approach what is meant by theoretical model? Award marks as follows: 2 marks for a clear definition of a theoretical model. 1 mark for a muddled or vague definition of a theoretical model. Possible content, • A hypothetical, visual representation of internal mental processes that cannot be directly seen. • An example of such a construct is the multi-store model of memory showing how memory processes are connected in a flow diagram as these are unseen and happen in the brain. Credit alternative wording.	2 AO1= 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
03	Irene and Phoebe are identical twin sisters. Irene says, “As we are identical, I can’t understand why I have anxiety, and you don’t.” Phoebe says, “I think the car crash you were in when you were 15 years old may have something to do with it.” Using your knowledge of genotype and phenotype, explain the conversation between Irene and Phoebe. Award marks as follows: 3 marks, the application of genotype and phenotype is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks, the application of genotype and phenotype lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark, the application of genotype and phenotype is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • Irene and Phoebe have the same genotype as they are identical (MZ) twins. • Irene and Phoebe have an identical genetic predisposition to suffer from anxiety. • Irene’s phenotype is different from Phoebe’s as Irene suffered early trauma (from the car crash) whereas Phoebe did not. • This would explain why Phoebe says Irene has anxiety and she does not because only Irene was in the car crash. Credit other relevant material. Note: A maximum of 1 mark if only genotype or phenotype is applied.	3 AO2 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
04	The biological approach suggests that genes influence behaviour. Explain one strength of this suggestion. Award marks as follows: 3 marks, the strength of the suggestion is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks, the strength of the suggestion lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark, the strength of the suggestion is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible strengths • There is support for the influence of genes from twin studies, eg Gottesman and Shields (1968) twin studies into schizophrenia who found concordance rates of 92% for MZ (identical) twins and 22% for DZ (non-identical) twins. • Offers the possibility of being able to pinpoint genes that cause certain behaviours and modify their effects through drugs or gene therapy, eg the COMT gene in schizophrenia or the MAOA gene in aggression. • Useful in identifying genetic predispositions and offering early assistance or advice to those who might be 'at risk', eg anger management therapy for those with the MAOA gene. Credit other relevant strengths.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
05	Six-year-old Shira likes to play with toy farm animals while her brother, three-year-old Amit, plays close by with the toy cars. Amit sees his mother praise Shira for how well she tidies the toy farm animals once she has finished playing. Recently, Amit has been trying to tidy the toy cars too. Describe and evaluate social learning theory. Refer to the behaviour of Shira and Amit in your answer. Possible content • Learning takes place in a social context. • Learning occurs via observation of the behaviour of others and the rewards or punishments received for the behaviour – vicarious reinforcement. • Other people act as models and the characteristics of models influence the likelihood of imitation of the behaviour. • Mediation processes, eg attention, retention, motivation, reproduction, affecting production of behaviour. • Concept of identification. • Reciprocal determinism and the concept of free will. • Description of research into social learning theory, eg Bandura et al. (1961) Bobo doll study. Possible application • Amit identifies with Shira because, as his older sibling, she is a role model. • Shira acts as a model for Amit so he is likely to imitate behaviour that brings reward for Shira (vicarious reinforcement). • Amit imitates Shira's behaviour because he observes her actions and the praise she received and copies them; he attempts to pack the toy cars away tidily. • Application referring to mediational processes, eg Amit has the motor ability to pick up small objects and tidy them away. Possible evaluation • Use of evidence to support social learning theory, eg Bandura et al. (1961) Bobo doll study. • Benefits of the experimental approach to investigate social learning theory. • Methodological issues with the Bobo doll study which may affect the conclusions drawn. • Accepts the influence of mediational processes on learning – neglected by behaviourists. • Provides explanations for aggression and other behaviours which may be influenced by social context. • Does not account for the impact of biological, heredity or maturational factors on behaviour, even though evidence from these areas of research shows they have an impact eg the role of testosterone in aggression. • Can account for cultural differences in behaviour, eg differences in co-operative behaviour in individualist and collectivist cultures. • Comparison with other approaches. Credit other relevant material.	20 AO1 = 8 AO2 = 4 AO3 = 8

	Level	Description	Marks	
	4	Knowledge of social learning theory is accurate and generally well detailed. Evaluation is effective. Application is appropriate. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	16–20	
	3	Knowledge of social learning theory is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective evaluation/application. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	11–15	
	2	Limited knowledge of social learning theory is present. Any evaluation/application is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	6–10	
	1	Knowledge of social learning theory is very limited. Evaluation/application is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–5	
	0	No creditable content.	0	

Section B: Issues and Debates in Psychology

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
06	Which of the following two statements about behaviour are true of a reductionist approach to behaviour? Shade two boxes. Answer key: D – Behaviour should be explained as basic units. F – Behaviour should be explained at the lowest level.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
07	Hans says, “I was always going to be good at horse riding. My mother and grandmother won lots of riding competitions. And I was given my first horse at a very young age so I have had plenty of practice.” Using your knowledge of the interactionist approach, explain Hans’ comments. Possible application • Hans’ viewpoint is an interactionist one because he recognises the importance of both nature (genes) and nurture (practice) in shaping his behaviour. • Hans acknowledges that a natural ability for horse riding might have been inherited from his mother and grandmother (nature), but he also understands that that having his first horse at a young age has allowed him to practise his skills (nurture). • Certain genes in mother/grandmother may have been modified through interacting with horses and these genes have been passed on to Hans (epigenetics). Credit other relevant application. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Application of the interactionist approach is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Application of the interactionist approach is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Application of the interactionist approach is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Application of the interactionist approach is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO2 = 4
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2	Application of the interactionist approach is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
08	Briefly evaluate the interactionist approach. Possible evaluation • Studies of nurture show that nature cannot be ignored, eg little Albert may have had a biological preparedness to fear rats. • Studies of nature show that the environment cannot be ignored, eg twin studies of schizophrenia where concordance between MZ twins is never 100%. • Theories of cognitive development demonstrate clear links between nature (stages develop in a biologically determined order) and nurture (interaction with different/personal environments explains individual differences in the rate of development), eg Piaget's stages of cognitive development. • The biopsychosocial approach recognises that many mental disorders develop through genetic predisposition and interaction with stressors in the environment. • Usefulness of interactionist approach for treatment of a number of disorders, eg a combination of drugs therapy and CBT is often found to be the most successful. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of the interactionist approach is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of the interactionist approach is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Evaluation of the interactionist approach is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Evaluation of the interactionist approach is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO3 = 4
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
09	Shiyao is planning to conduct an experiment to investigate if there is a difference in the amount of time it takes to read a passage of text when it is written using either a green or a blue pen. Using your knowledge of psychology and science, suggest one way Shiyao can make her research falsifiable and one way she can make it replicable. Award marks as follows: 2 marks for a clear way to make Shiyao's research falsifiable 1 mark for a muddled or vague way to make Shiyao's research falsifiable Possible ways of making the research falsifiable • Shiyao could write a hypothesis that can be tested/falsified. • In the hypothesis, Shiyao needs to include the operationalised dependent variable of time taken, and the operationalised independent variable of blue or green ink. Plus 2 marks for a clear way to make Shiyao's research replicable. 1 mark for a muddled or vague way to make Shiyao's research replicable Possible ways of making the research replicable • Shiyao should standardise her materials and procedure so that her research can be repeated exactly. • She should use the same text for both conditions and ensure that her procedure is written down so it can be followed precisely. Credit other relevant material.	4 AO2 = 4

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
10	Briefly explain two strengths of using the empirical method in psychology. Possible content • Allows for cause and effect to be established by isolating and testing an independent variable to see the effect on the dependent variable. • The empirical method is respected and valued by the scientific community and by the public. Scientific research findings have credibility. • Allows for the control of extraneous variables and for things to be studied objectively through direct observation. • Makes it possible to create general laws which apply to everyone and which help to predict future behaviour. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Explanation of two strengths is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Explanation of two strengths is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Explanation of two strengths is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Explanation of two strengths is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO3 = 4
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks															
11	Outline the free will and determinism debate. Possible content • The free will and determinism debate focuses on how much of our behaviour is determined by forces beyond our control versus how much choice we have over our behaviour. • Free will is the belief that our behaviour is governed by our choices and/or only minimally determined by other forces. • Soft determinism means while most aspects of behaviour are caused by the external/internal factor actual behaviour is open to some free will. • Determinism is the belief that all behaviour is caused by internal or external forces beyond our control. • Types of determinism, eg soft/hard determinism, biological/environmental determinism. • Examples to illustrate types of determinism, eg genes passed on from our parents determine our behaviour. • Determinism underpins psychology as a scientific discipline, it allows us to establish cause and effect. Credit other relevant material. Note: For credit at Level 3 there must be clear reference to the extent to which we have control or not over our behaviour. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Knowledge of the free will and determinism debate is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Knowledge of the free will and determinism debate is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Knowledge the free will and determinism debate is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Knowledge of the free will and determinism debate is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6	2	Knowledge of the free will and determinism debate is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Knowledge the free will and determinism debate is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO1 = 6
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
12	Explain one strength and one limitation of taking a free will approach to explaining behaviour. Award marks as follows: 3 marks, the explanation of a strength of taking a free will approach is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks, the explanation of a strength of taking a free will approach lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark, the explanation of a strength of taking a free will approach is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible strengths • Free will is an essential component in the justice system. This allows people to be held accountable for the choices they make. • The belief that we have choice is essential for good mental health and wellbeing because it suggests that we can choose to improve our lives. • It is the philosophical basis of holistic approaches such as the humanistic approach. It allows us to believe that we can self-actualise. Plus 3 marks, the explanation of a limitation of taking a free will approach is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks, the explanation of a limitation of taking a free will approach lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark, the explanation of a limitation of taking a free will approach is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible limitations • A belief in free will is not compatible with a scientific approach which uses experiments to establish cause and effect relationships. • It does not allow us to predict behaviour as, since we have a free choice, it may be different each time. • Free will is very difficult to test scientifically, it is an abstract concept that cannot be falsified. Credit other relevant strengths and limitations.	6 AO3 = 6

Section C: Applied Psychology: Work and the Individual

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
13	What is meant by risky shift and by groupthink? Award 1 mark for each correct definition Risky shift: when both the group and the individual support a riskier decision. Groupthink: when the desire for group cohesiveness results in an irrational or dysfunctional outcome. Accept alternative wording.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks									
14	In an experiment on group processes, participants were asked to perform two tasks. Each task was performed both with an audience and without an audience. The first task, a simple task, was sorting objects by colour. The second task, a complex task, was sorting objects by shape. The results are shown in Table 1 below. Table 1 Mean times taken (in seconds) to complete each task. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th></th><th>Simple task (seconds)</th><th>Complex task (seconds)</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Without an audience</td><td>28</td><td>32</td></tr> <tr> <td>With an audience</td><td>20</td><td>45</td></tr> </tbody> </table> Using your knowledge of social facilitation, explain the findings of this experiment. Award marks as follows: 3 marks, the application of knowledge of social facilitation is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks, the application of knowledge of social facilitation lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark, the application of knowledge of social facilitation is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible application - When in front of an audience, individuals perform better on simple tasks. Participants were (8 seconds) quicker at sorting the coloured objects when in front of an audience than when alone. - When in front of an audience, individuals perform worse on complex tasks. Participants were (13 seconds) slower at sorting objects by shape in front of an audience than when alone. Accept alternative wording.		Simple task (seconds)	Complex task (seconds)	Without an audience	28	32	With an audience	20	45	3 AO2 = 3
	Simple task (seconds)	Complex task (seconds)									
Without an audience	28	32									
With an audience	20	45									

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
15	Briefly evaluate social facilitation as an explanation for group processes. Possible evaluation • Use of studies to support social facilitation effects, eg Triplett (1897) cyclists were slower racing against the clock than when racing against other cyclists. • Led to further development of social facilitation theory to explain differences in performance due to simple (passive) audience effects and co-action effects. • Certain individual differences may make some people more susceptible to social facilitation regardless of task complexity, than others, eg Uziel (2006) performance of extraverts with high self esteem will improve whilst performance of those high in neuroticism with low self-esteem will become worse. • Other variables due to age, experience and cross-cultural factors may also affect performance, so social facilitation may be an incomplete explanation. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1" data-bbox="304 1028 1302 1431"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of social facilitation is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of social facilitation is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Evaluation of social facilitation is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Evaluation of social facilitation is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO3 = 4
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16	Bai works as a nurse in a busy hospital. The hospital is short of staff, so he has too many tasks to complete in his shifts. He also has to deal with upset families, for which he has had little training. These demands make Bai unhappy and lack motivation. Bai receives positive feedback from patients and managers and feels he has the skills and knowledge to perform his job well. However, he has little control over his work schedule and lacks opportunities to participate in decision-making about hospital policies that affect him. Using your knowledge of the job demands-resources (JD-R) model, explain what hospital managers could do to improve Bai's happiness and motivation at work. Possible content • The hospital managers could look at ways to provide Bai with more decision latitude over his schedule. • Managers could employ more nurses to reduce Bai's workload, therefore reducing the demand. • They could provide debriefing sessions to deal with emotional demands and provide training, eg how to break bad news and deal with angry patients. This will make Bai feel more confident. • They could involve Bai in some committee decisions to increase his sense of autonomy. This will improve Bai's motivation. • They could offer Bai regular feedback on his work so that he can see his progress and feel happier and more motivated about his personal growth and development. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Application of the JD-R model is detailed and appropriate/effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Application of the JD-R model is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Application of the JD-R model is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Application of the JD-R model is detailed and appropriate/effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6	2	Application of the JD-R model is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Application of the JD-R model is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO2 = 6
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks															
17	Evaluate the job demands-resources (JD-R) model as an explanation for workplace stress. Possible evaluation • Research support, eg Neilsen et al (2011) study of offshore oil workers. Higher levels of risk perception (demand) correlated with low job satisfaction, and positive perceptions of the company's safety culture (resource) correlated with high job satisfaction. • A more realistic model than the original JD-C version as it includes a larger range of variables relevant to the workplace. • The addition of job resources, eg training and feedback on performance as well as level of control, make this a highly dynamic and flexible model that can be applied to any work setting. • The model is capable of changing to fit new working environments as relationships between demands and resources evolve, eg moving towards a new digital age. • The addition of resources also provides a range of potential interventions to reduce strain and burnout in the workplace. • Difficult to test the model in one study as it is impossible to operationalise so many variables at once. • Comparing findings from studies is difficult as there will likely be such a range of demands and resources that no two studies will be testing the same thing. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Evaluation of the JD-R is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of the JD-R model is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of the JD-R model is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Evaluation of the JD-R is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6	2	Evaluation of the JD-R model is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Evaluation of the JD-R model is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO3 = 6
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3	Evaluation of the JD-R is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6															
2	Evaluation of the JD-R model is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4															
1	Evaluation of the JD-R model is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2															
0	No creditable content.	0															

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
18	Outline and evaluate goal-setting theory as an explanation of job motivation and satisfaction. Possible content • Developed from equity theory by Locke (1975) who suggested that goals guide and direct work behaviour and performance and lead to consequences, eg monetary reward and/or praise. • The components of goal-setting theory are goal difficulty, goal specificity, goal acceptance and goal commitment. This refers to the extent to which a goal is challenging, has clarity and precision, is accepted by the person, and how personally interested they are in achieving the goal. • Examples of types of goals, eg mastery and performance. • Goals should be specific and challenging but not too challenging or they become demotivating. • Clear and accurate feedback about performance is required to maximise performance. Possible evaluation • Evidence to support the effectiveness of goal setting, eg Latham and Blades (1975) with long haulage truck drivers. Goal specificity found to be effective in improving performance. • Further research into practical implications found that goals should be specific, achievable and set collaboratively to be more effective, eg Locke and Latham (1990). • Led to development of the SMART technique which can be used to improve performance and motivation in a variety of settings, eg Bouvend'Eerd et al. (1998). • Can be applied to all settings and cultures as the setting of achievable goals works the same for everyone, eg Farrell et al. (2005). • Goals that are too far above an employee's skills and competencies can have a negative effect on the employee's performance and their motivation to complete the goal. • More complex and difficult goals may lead to risky behaviour in an attempt to accomplish the goals in a timely manner and this could lead to mistakes being made or to ill health. Credit other relevant material.	9 AO1 = 4 AO3 = 5

	Level	Description	Marks	
	3	Knowledge of goal-setting theory is detailed and appropriate. Evaluation is effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	7–9	
	2	Knowledge of goal-setting theory is present. Any evaluation is mostly effective. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	4–6	
	1	Knowledge of goal-setting theory is very limited. Evaluation is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–3	
	0	No creditable content.	0	

PS04 grid

	AO1	AO2	AO3	Total
Section A				
01	2			2
02	2			2
03		3		3
04			3	3
05	8	4	8	20
Section B				
06	2			2
07		4		4
08			4	4
09		4		4
10			4	4
11	6			6
12			6	6
Section C				
13	2			2
14		3		3
15			4	4
16		6		6
17			6	6
18	4		5	9
Unit total	26	24	40	90